The Mountain of Moriah

Genesis 22:1–19 · Romans 8:32

The big idea: God tested Abraham: "Take your son, your only son Isaac, whom you love." Abraham trusted that God would provide, and God provided a ram instead of his son. On Calvary God did not spare his own Son, the Lamb he had promised.

Before you meet: Read

Genesis 22:1–19 | Hebrews 11:17–19 | Romans 8:31–32

Open (5 minutes)

Have you ever had to give up something you loved? What helped you let go?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"God will _____ for himself the lamb for a burnt offering, my son." *(Genesis 22:8)*

"And Abraham went and took the ram and offered it up as a burnt offering _____ of his son." *(Genesis 22:13)*

"He who did not _____ his own Son but gave him up for us all…" *(Romans 8:32)*

Discuss

1. Isaac carried the wood up the mountain, and a ram died in his place. Jesus carried his cross, and no one took his place. If God did not spare his own Son, where do you need to trust him to "graciously give us all things" this week? *Genesis 22:6–13; Romans 8:32*

2. Abraham told his servants, "I and the boy will go over there and worship and come again to you." What did he believe God would do? *Genesis 22:5; Hebrews 11:19*

3. "Instead of his son." Where else in the Bible have you seen a substitute die in someone's place? *Genesis 3:21; 22:13; John 1:29*

Memory verse

"He who did not spare his own Son but gave him up for us all, how will he not also with him graciously give us all things?"

Romans 8:32

Pray

Thank God for the ram in the thicket and for the Lamb on the cross. Give back to him in prayer one gift you are tempted to love more than him, and trust him to provide.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 12

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Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read Genesis 22:1–19 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (Genesis 25:19–34, 27–28, and 32:22–32).

Main points to land

1. Moriah was a test from the first line, and God himself stopped it (Gen. 22:1, 12).
2. On Moriah God provided a ram instead of Isaac. On Calvary God did not spare his own Son, the Lamb of God who takes away the sin of the world (Gen. 22:13; Rom. 8:32; John 1:29).
3. Faith alone justifies, and justifying faith is never alone. Abraham was counted righteous decades before Moriah, and Moriah showed his faith was real (Gen. 15:6; James 2:21–23; WCF 11.2).

Answer key (Observe)

1. provide
2. instead
3. spare

Questions people will ask

How could God tell Abraham to sacrifice his own son?

Let the group feel the weight of it. Genesis says from the first line that this was a test (22:1), and God stopped it. Later he forbade child sacrifice as something "which I did not command, nor did it come into my mind" (Jer. 7:31). Abraham expected to come back with Isaac, because God was able to raise him from the dead (Gen. 22:5; Heb. 11:19). The scene points ahead to the Father who did not spare his own Son.

Closing prayer

Father, we cannot read this chapter without trembling. Thank you that on Moriah you stopped the knife and provided a ram, and that on Calvary you did not spare your own Son, but gave him up for us all. Teach us to hold every gift loosely and to trust you to provide. Amen.